

Epics / User Stories

Category 1 (n8n Automation)

Epic: Tool Integration & Workflow Automation

Connect the currently fragmented tools — JIRA, spreadsheets, calendars, and email — into a unified workflow so that project approvals, consultant assignments, and updates flow automatically across systems without manual re-entry or chasing.

User Story 1.1 *As Michelle Zhang (Senior Project Manager), I want project approvals in JIRA to automatically trigger a staffing workflow, so that I don't have to manually monitor JIRA for new projects and re-enter data into the spreadsheet separately.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- When a project is approved in JIRA, a staffing task is automatically created and assigned to the relevant PM
- The staffing task pre-populates with project requirements, timeline, and required skills pulled from the JIRA ticket
- Michelle receives a notification within 15 minutes of a new project approval
- No manual data re-entry between JIRA and the staffing system is required
- Once consultants are assigned, the JIRA project record is automatically updated to reflect the team

User Story 1.2 *As Robert Singh (VP of Talent & Operations), I want consultant calendar availability to sync automatically with the staffing system, so that Michelle/PMs no longer needs to manually follow up with each consultant to confirm whether they are free.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- Consultant calendars are integrated with the staffing system and update in real time
- If a consultant's calendar has not been updated within a defined period, an automated reminder is sent to that consultant
- PMs can see confirmed vs. unconfirmed availability at a glance before making assignments
- Availability data feeds directly into the capacity dashboard without any manual step
- Calendar sync is compliant with GDPR data handling requirements

User Story 1.3 *As the Silver Trust operations team, I want all project and staffing data to exist in one connected system, so that accounting, HR, and project management teams are working from the same information without maintaining separate tools in parallel.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- JIRA project data, staffing spreadsheet logic, consultant calendars, and HR workload flags are accessible from a single interface
- Data entered in one tool propagates automatically to connected systems without manual re-entry
- Accounting and procurement teams can view project-relevant status without needing full JIRA access

- The system includes an audit trail showing when and by whom any record was last updated
- All integrations are documented and do not require Michelle's personal knowledge to maintain or hand over

Category 2 (AI/LLM Features)

Epic: Resource Capacity & Staffing Intelligence

Replace the manual, gut-feel capacity planning process and Michelle's "black book" spreadsheet with a centralised AI-powered system that tracks consultant availability, skills, workload, and project fit — making staffing decisions faster, data-driven, and not dependent on any single person.

User Story 2.1 *As Robert Singh (VP of Talent & Operations), I want an AI-powered capacity dashboard that analyses current allocations and recommends whether the firm can take on a new project, so that I can make staffing decisions in under 30 minutes rather than spending 2–3 days gathering information manually.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- Dashboard displays all 30 consultants with current allocation percentage, availability dates, and a recommended capacity verdict for any incoming project
- AI generates a ranked list of suitable consultants for a new project based on availability, skills, workload, relationship dynamics, and mentoring possibilities.
- Robert can input a proposed project scope and receive an immediate capacity recommendation
- Decision support explanations are shown alongside each recommendation so Robert understands the reasoning
- Decision time for project acceptance is reduced from 2–3 days to under 30 minutes

User Story 2.2 *As Michelle Zhang (Senior Project Manager), I want the AI to flag skill mismatches and suggest compatible team compositions before a consultant is assigned, so that staffing decisions no longer depend solely on my personal knowledge of who works well with whom.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- The system cross-references project requirements against consultant skill profiles before confirming any assignment
- A warning is shown when a consultant lacks one or more required skills, with alternative suggestions provided
- AI suggests team compositions based on past project performance data, including compatibility signals from previous collaborations
- Michelle can override any AI suggestion with a documented reason, which is logged for future model improvement
- All PMs can use the system to produce a qualified staffing recommendation without being dependent on Michele.

User Story 2.3 *As Michelle Zhang (Senior Project Manager), I want consultant profiles to capture skills, availability, workload, and compatibility notes in a structured system, so that staffing decisions can be made by any PM — not just me — without losing the institutional knowledge currently held in my spreadsheet.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- Each consultant has a profile containing skills, active projects, availability, and soft notes (e.g. workload flags, compatibility)
- Profiles are editable by any authorised PM, not just Michelle
- When Michelle is absent, another PM can staff a project using the system without needing to contact her
- All data is GDPR-compliant and access-controlled by role.

Epic: Consultant Workload & Development Visibility

Surface real-time workload data per consultant to prevent overallocation and burnout, and introduce structured junior-senior pairing logic to support mentoring and talent development as the firm scales.

User Story 3.1 *As Robert Singh (VP of Talent & Operations), I want the AI to proactively flag overallocation and burnout risk per consultant, so that I can redistribute work before burnout occurs rather than finding out reactively through HR meetings.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- Each consultant has a workload threshold; yellow flag at 80% capacity, red flag at 100%, with automatic alerts sent to Robert and the relevant PM
- The alert includes which projects are causing the overload and AI-suggested alternative consultants
- Keisha Williams cannot be added to a new project when flagged red without an explicit documented override
- A monthly workload distribution summary is auto-generated for Robert's review
- Workload data is visible on the capacity dashboard from the previous epic

User Story 3.2 *As Keisha Williams (Senior Consultant), I want my mentoring commitments to be visible in the staffing system as a protected time allocation, so that project assignments don't continually crowd out development work.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- Mentoring sessions can be logged as recurring time blocks that count toward Keisha's allocated capacity
- The system treats mentoring time as non-negotiable unless manually overridden by a PM with documented justification
- David Park's development goals are visible alongside his project assignments in his consultant profile
- A monthly summary of mentoring hours vs. planned hours is auto-generated for Robert to review

User Story 3.3 *As David Park (Junior Consultant), I want the AI to match me to projects that include a deliberate development component, so that I build skills progressively rather than being assigned reactively whenever a senior consultant is unavailable.*

Acceptance Criteria:

- David's profile includes a skill development roadmap with target competencies
- The AI flags when a project assignment would contribute to a listed development goal and surfaces this during the staffing decision
- When David is assigned to a complex project, the system automatically recommends a senior consultant pairing on the same project

- Junior consultants are never assigned as the sole resource on a complex project without a senior pairing flagged in the system
- A quarterly skills progress report is generated showing growth against the development roadmap

Prioritisation rationale:

Highest stories are the ones that directly address the two most critical and quantified pain points from the interview — the 2–3 day capacity bottleneck and the single-point-of-failure risk around Michelle's black book. Nothing else can be built effectively until consultant profiles exist (2.3 is a dependency for 2.1 and 2.2) and until JIRA triggers are in place (1.1 is the foundation for 1.2 and 1.3).

High stories build on the Highest tier and address the next most urgent risks — overallocation of key staff and the manual calendar-chasing step that adds hidden time to every staffing cycle.

Medium and Low stories are valuable but not blocking — they address scaling and development concerns that matter for the 15-month growth plan but don't need to be solved in the first sprint to deliver immediate value to Robert and Michelle.

JIRA Project documentation

Link to the JIRA Project: <https://ai-consulting-eb.atlassian.net/jira/software/projects/PDM/boards/1/backlog?epics=visible>

Epic view (all epics)

Epic



☒ No epic

>  Tool Integration
& Workflow Automation ...

>  Resource
Capacity & Staffing Intelligence ...

>  Consultant
Workload & Development Visibility ...

Backlog view (epics and user stories)

Spaces

AI Consulting

SummaryBacklogBoardCalendarTimelinePagesForms

Search ba...Filter

Epic

No epic

Tool Integration & Workflow Automation

Resource Capacity & Staffing Intelligence

Consultant Workload & Development Visibility

+ Create epic

PDM Sprint 1

Add dates (3 work items)

000Start sprint

PDM-10

Jira - Staffing System Integration

TOOL INTEGRATION ...

TO DO

-

PDM-13

AI-powered capacity dashboard

RESOURCE CAPACIT...

TO DO

-

PDM-15

Comprehensive consultant profiles stored in th...

RESOURCE CAPACIT...

TO DO

-

+ Create

3 of 3 work items visible | Estimate: 0 of 0

Backlog

(6 work items)

000Create sprint

Create a whiteboard to plan your work

TRY

...

X

PDM-11

Calendar - Staffing System integration

TOOL INTEG...

TO DO

-

PDM-12

Connected system for project, staffing, and financial data

TOOL INTEG...

TO DO

-

PDM-14

AI skill flagging and compatibility suggestions

RESOURCE C...

TO DO

-

PDM-16

AI overallocation and burnout risk flagging

CONSULTAN...

TO DO

-

PDM-17

Explicit time allocation for mentoring commitments

CONSULTAN...

TO DO

-

Board view (sprint structure)

Spaces

AI Consulting

SummaryBacklogBoardCalendarTimelinePagesForms

Search ba...Filter

PDM Sprint 1

Add dates (3 work items)

000Start sprint

PDM-10

Jira - Staffing System Integration

TOOL INTEGRATION ...

TO DO

-

PDM-13

AI-powered capacity dashboard

RESOURCE CAPACIT...

TO DO

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PDM-15

Comprehensive consultant profiles stored in the staffing system

RESOURCE CAPACIT...

TO DO

-

+ Create

3 of 3 work items visible | Estimate: 0 of 0

One user story showing acceptance criteria

Spaces / AI Consulting / PDM-7 / PDM-10

Jira - Staffing System Integration

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▼ Description

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To Do ▼ ⚡ ⚙ Improve Story

▼ Details ⚙

Assignee

Unassigned

Assign to me

Labels

Category1

Parent

PDM-7 Tool Integration &

Due date

None

Team

None

Start date

None

Story point estimate

None

Sprint

PDM Sprint 1

Sprint Planning Reflection — Silver Trust

How did you translate stakeholder pain points into epics?

We grouped pain points by the underlying gap they pointed to rather than by feature type. Robert's 2–3 day capacity cycle and Michelle's black book both pointed to a missing centralised staffing system — that became one epic. The constant re-entry between JIRA, spreadsheets, and calendars pointed to tool fragmentation — that became another. Workload and development visibility emerged from Keisha's overextension and the firm's scaling ambitions as a third.

What was challenging about writing user stories?

Staying anchored to what stakeholders need rather than how the system should work. Naming a specific persona and linking each story back to a concrete moment from the transcript helped avoid writing stories that were really solution designs in disguise.

How did you prioritize your backlog?

By combining pain point severity with dependency order — the most critical problems first, and within those, the stories that other stories depend on. Consultant profiles had to come before the capacity dashboard; the JIRA trigger had to come before any downstream automation.

What questions or assumptions did you make?

Given the limited information from a single interview, a significant number of assumptions had to be made — particularly around what Michelle's spreadsheet actually contains, how mature the JIRA setup is, what data is accessible under GDPR, and whether the sales-to-delivery handoff has any existing structure. Without answers to these, several of our stories rest on unverified foundations. The most pressing open questions are documented below.

Open questions for the next customer meeting

- **What exactly lives in Michelle's black book?** Can we get a full walkthrough of the spreadsheet's structure, logic, and edge cases before designing a replacement — this is the single most important piece of system knowledge we currently don't have.
- **What data can we actually access?** Which consultant and project data is available for the solution design, what requires HR and legal sign-off under GDPR, and who is the compliance point of contact we should loop in early?
- **How does the sales-to-delivery handoff currently work?** Where does a new project officially enter the delivery team's awareness, and is there any structured brief that comes with it or does Robert and Michelle start from scratch each time?
- **How are consultant skills currently assessed and documented?** Is there any existing framework, or does all skill and compatibility knowledge live entirely in Michelle's head — and if the latter, how do we capture it before it becomes a design risk?
- **If we could only solve one problem in the first sprint, what would it be?** Specifically — does Robert prioritise getting faster capacity decisions, or does Michelle prioritise reducing her manual staffing workload? Their answer will define our MVP scope.